

Ana Brassard

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Sendai, Miyagi, Japan

Current

Postdoctoral Researcher, RIKEN AIP Natural Language Understanding Team

*Conducting independent and collaborative academic research focusing on the **interpretability** and **mechanistic understanding** of LLMs and LMMs. (Feb. 2026 - now)*

Research interests

LM reasoning & understanding, LLM testing, probing, and diagnostics; robustness and interpretability; dataset creation.

 GitHub: /a-brassard

Mainly **Python**, **PyTorch**-based deep learning, AMT crowdsourcing, API-based LLMs.

English (fluent), Japanese (N1), French (intermediate), Croatian (native).

Ph.D. in Information Science

2021 - 2025, Graduate School of Information Sciences, Tohoku University

Master of Science in Computing

2016 - 2018, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, University of Zagreb

Bachelor of Science in Computing

2013 - 2016, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, University of Zagreb

Previous Work Experience

* Dec. 2018 - Jan. 2026: Technical Staff I, RIKEN AIP Natural Language Understanding Team

Selected Publications

- * Alazraki, L., Chen, L., Brassard, A., Stacey, J., Rahmani, H. A., & Rei, M. (2025). AgentCoMa: A compositional benchmark mixing commonsense and mathematical reasoning in real-world scenarios. *Preprint*.
- * Kudo, K., Aoki, Y., Kuribayashi, T., Sone, S., Taniguchi, M., Brassard, A., Sakaguchi, K., & Inui, K. (2025). LLMs Faithfully and Iteratively Compute Answers During CoT: A Systematic Analysis With Multi-step Arithmetics. *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL 2026*.
- * Kamoda, G., Asai, A., Brassard, A., & Sakaguchi, K. (2025). Quantifying the Influence of Evaluation Aspects on Long-Form Response Assessment. COLING 2025.
- * Shiono, D., Brassard, A., Ishizuki, Y., & Suzuki, J. (2025). Evaluating Model Alignment with Human Perception: A Study on Shitsukan in LLMs and LVLMs. COLING 2025.
- * Brassard, A., Heinzerling, B., Kudo, K., Sakaguchi, K., & Inui, K. (2024). ACORN: Aspect-wise Commonsense Reasoning Explanation Evaluation. COLM 2024.
- * Brassard, A., Heinzerling, B., Kavumba, P., & Inui, K. (2022). COPA-SSE: Semi-structured Explanations for Commonsense Reasoning. LREC 2022.